



PROFESSOR DEE (DEIRDRE) PRATT CURRICULUM VITAE

CONTACT DETAILS:



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OVERVIEW

Professor Pratt worked as Research Co-ordinator for the Faculty of Arts and Design (FAD) up to her retirement in December 2010, and is now continuing with higher degree supervision and research publications. Her supervision includes doctoral and master's students in the following disciplines:

- Chiropractic (Masters)
- Drama and Performance Studies (PhD)
- Education (PhD: Education; Masters in Community and Adult Education)
- Fashion and Textiles (Masters: Fashion)
- Information Technology (PhD)
- Journalism (Masters)
- Media, Language & Communication (PhD and Masters: Language Practice)
- Visual Communication Design (Masters: Graphic Design, Photography; PhD: Visual and Performing Arts)

Her specialist research area is systemic modelling, which has practical application in communication, curriculum design, ICT and research. The specialist applications of the modelling theory are as follows: lecturing in language/communication, designing e-learning courses and computer applications, and research practice/supervision. She also designed, set up and ran mixed-mode Research Modules (on Moodle) for higher degree students, and has supervised two international students entirely online. After being recognised as Faculty Quality Champion in 2006, she chaired the Arts and Design Quality Commission in 2006/2007. She organised and chaired the *FAD Conference 2009*, which focused on the creative output of the Faculty of Arts and Design. She has published three books related to her doctoral research and its applications. While she retired from full time employment at the end of 2010, she is continuing her long association with DUT in the capacity of Adjunct Professor.

ACADEMIC AND PROFESSIONAL QUALIFICATIONS/AWARDS

- BA (Majors English and Latin) (University of Natal, 1966)
- University Education Diploma (University of Natal, 1967)
- Applied Linguistics Honours (University of Natal, 1982)
- MA in Applied Linguistics, *cum laude* (University of Natal, 1988)
- HEQC Evaluator (Council on Higher Education, 2007)
- Mastery Level Certificate in Assessor Training (Durban University of Technology, 2007)
- DTech in Language Practice (Durban University of Technology, 2008)
- Associate Professor (Durban University of Technology, 2010)
- Adjunct Professor (Durban University of Technology, 2021)

She is a member of the following professional associations:

- IASTED (International Association of Science and Technology for Development)
- NADEOSA (An association of 58 organisations committed to promoting access to lifelong learning of high quality)

She worked with Industry specialists Syntares (freelance software developers) to develop the *Writing Tutor* software.

In 2007 she was Faculty Representative on the *DUT Teaching and Learning Committee*, Convener of the Policy Writing Task Team for the *DUT e-Learning Policy* and contributed to the *DUT Assessment Policy*. In 2010 she was nominated by the Creative Outputs task team as Co-ordinator of DUT faculty assessment procedures. She received a long-service award in 2010 after 20 years of DUT service. In 2012 she was invited to join the DUT Space Science Research Group.

SHORT COURSES AND TRAINING WORKSHOPS ATTENDED

These do not include workshops attended at overseas conferences and numerous Faculty workshops, or the workshops facilitated by Professor Pratt:

- *E-Grad School Supervisor Solutions Workshop for Experienced Supervisors*, Prof. Rod Wissler, Hotel School Conference Venue, 16/04/2010)
- *Writing a Good Dissertation*, Prof. Alta van der Merwe, Meraka Institute (DUT Hotel School Conference Venue, 1-2/03/2009)
- *Enhancing Academic Integrity*, FAD TDG Workshop, Nicky Muller (13/10/2008, Blue Waters Hotel, Durban)
- *HESA Workshop* (deputising for Executive Dean, on 12/08/2008, Birchwood Hotel, Boksburg)
- *Proposal Writing Workshop*, Professor Sioux McKenna, UKZN (1-2/08/2008, Protea Hotel, Karridene)
- *Research Policy Writing Workshops*, Professor Gansen Pillay (3-4/04/2007 at Palm Lodge, Blythesdale Beach, and 7-8/11/2007, Protea Hotel, Karridene)
- *Assessor Training Workshop*, Lawrence Olivier and Charl Fregona (16-17/05/2005, CHED, ML Sultan Campus, DUT)
- *Evaluator Preparation Workshop for the National Review of Teacher Education*, CHE (21-22/07/2005, Edgewood College, Pinetown)
- *Pioneers 2002*, Mari Pete and Charl Fregona (2nd Semester 2002) Online Learning Centre, DIT)

DUT Research Processes, Policies and Procedures 2019-2024

From 2010 - 2024 she attended Higher Degree Committee to assist with DUT research processes, policies and procedures, including:

- Postgraduate Admissions Policy
- Higher Degrees Assessment Policy
- Supervision Policy
- Plagiarism Policy
- e-Learning Policy

She also assisted with updating and editing the following:

- 2011 - 2024 PG Forms
- 2011 - 2024 Postgraduate Student Guide

In 2021/2023, she served as an executive member of the team engaged in automating DUT higher degree examination administration.

INTERNATIONAL LINKAGES

Professor Pratt has international linkages which were established with academics during overseas international conferences and contacts maintained with colleagues who have moved to overseas universities. In 2009 she was invited to join the Academic Advisory Board for the Graduate School, Korea Education, to advise on

distance learning for the Graduate School of International Education KEISIE, and has also served on the Board of Associate Editors for the *International Journal of Learning*. She collaborated with Professor Ramu Naidoo in the signing of an MOU with Saurashtra University (Rajkot). She has worked with *Methodos* series (Kluwer/Springer, Dordrecht) editors Professors Robert Franck and Daniel Courgeau in producing a definitive work on social science modelling, and with LAP Publishers (Germany) in producing a book on video protocol analyses, an original research methodology developed to analyse and encode composing behaviour. She collaborated with Dublin University on a project involving the development of an online module for research methods and acted as Associate Editor for the *International Journal for Transformative Research*, as well as a Reviewer for the *Journal of Systemics, Cybernetics and Informatics*.

SPECIALIST RESEARCH AND SUPERVISION AREAS

Systemic modelling, with application in the following areas:

- Language and Literacy
- Computer Mediated Learning
- Curriculum design

She also has specialist knowledge of the critical realist research orientation, but her supervision includes students using post-modern approaches and self-study.

HIGHER DEGREE STUDENTS SUPERVISED 2006 - present

1. Bar-Gil, M.C. The perception of selected chiropractors, medical doctors, health maintenance organisation representatives and chiropractic patients regarding the integration of the chiropractic profession in the Israeli health care system. MTech (Chiropractic). Graduated April 2009. **Supervisor**.
2. Gutteridge, R.G. The impact of socio-cultural factors on blended learning in the development of academic literacy in a tertiary vocational context. MTech (Education). Graduated September 2009. **Supervisor**.
3. Sheridan, R. The language of digital learning: developing an e-learning approach for the elderly. DTech (Language Practice), graduated September 2010. [OVERSEAS INTERNATIONAL STUDENT: USA] **Supervisor**.
4. Wise, R. The perceptions of key stakeholders on the integration of Chiropractic into the KwaZulu-Natal health care system. MTech (Chiropractic). Graduated September 2010. **Supervisor**.
5. Govender, R. A critical realist approach to literacy acquisition and development, with specific application to teacher training and support in primary education in KwaZulu-Natal. DTech (Language Practice). Graduated September 2011. **Supervisor**.
6. Dorasamy, R.S. The impact of English as medium of instruction on the academic performance of second language learners in the Further Education and Training band at schools in KwaZulu-Natal. DTech (Language Practice). Graduated April 2012. **Sole Supervisor**.
7. Makhubu, R.L. Development of an interpreting services model for the Durban University of Technology. DTech (Language Practice). Graduated April 2012. **Supervisor**.

8. Naidoo, J. The hegemonic position of English as a medium of instruction at primary school level in KwaZulu-Natal, and its impact on parents' preferences of schooling for their children. DTech (Language Practice). Graduated April 2012. **Supervisor.**
9. Peat, B. Integrated arts as transformational medium of instruction in Kwazulu-Natal schools: a narrative self-study. DTech (Language Practice). Graduated April 2012. **Supervisor.**
10. Soni, S. A self study of curriculum design for the teaching and learning of isiZulu as an additional language in primary schools in the "Maye Babo!" series. DTech (Language Practice). Graduated April 2012. **Supervisor.**
11. Bosman, J. The status quo of animal chiropractic in South Africa. MTech (Chiropractic). Graduated April 2012. **Co-Supervisor.**
12. Lichkus, S.C. The creation of a multicultural identity for window displays in Durban's major fashion retail shop fronts. MTech (Fashion). Graduated April 2012. **Co-Supervisor.**
13. Slattery, L. The effect of anti-establishment branding on teenage consumer behaviour within the action sportswear market. MTech (Fashion). Graduated April 2013. **Co-Supervisor.**
14. Buist, S. Conflicts of interest in the reporting of biomedical research in mainstream newspapers in Canada. MTech (Journalism). [OVERSEAS INTERNATIONAL STUDENT: CANADA] Graduated *cum laude* September 2013. **Supervisor.**
15. Schultz, W. The Eco-Bride: an environmentally-friendly bridal range for a South African market. MTech (Fashion). Graduated *cum laude* September 2013. **Co-Supervisor.**
16. Reddy, P. (Pregalathan) A learning object repository for computer assisted language learning. MTech (Language Practice). Graduated *cum laude* April 2014. **Supervisor.**
17. Somlenze, M. The use of graphic design materials as a resource to address the issue of literacy acquisition in rural schools of the Eastern Cape. MTech (Graphic Design). Graduated *cum laude* April 2014. **Supervisor.**
18. Bhorat, A.H.M. A curated online educational portal for staff and students at a University of Technology. DTech (Language Practice). Graduated April 2015. **Sole Supervisor.**
19. Coetzee, M. Addressing the skills shortage of computer aided design pattern-making in the KwaZulu-Natal clothing industry. MTech (Fashion). Graduated April 2015. **Co-Supervisor.**
20. Els, L. The impact of medium of instruction on the learning of Computer Applications Technology. MTech (Language Practice). Graduated September 2015. **Supervisor.**
21. Govindsamy, L. A critical linguistic discourse analysis of religious observances in public schools to establish the hegemonic influence of colonial religious observances and their effect on the school population. PhD in Language Practice. Graduated April 2016. **Supervisor.**

22. Muindi, T.H. The influence of television soap operas on Zulu traditional marriages. Master of Journalism. Graduated *cum laude* September 2016. **Supervisor.**
23. Mindry, M. Controlled shadow in photography: the development of a technique for child portraiture. Master of Applied Arts in Photography. Graduated May 2017. **Supervisor.**
24. Reddy, K. A critical linguistic discourse analysis of participant narratives in the construction of citizenship education at a University of Technology. PhD in Language Practice. Graduated September 2017. **Sole Supervisor.**
25. Rambrij, R. Technology literacy for teachers in rural schools: constructing key concepts in Technology Education for teachers in the Ilembe District. PhD in Language Practice. Graduated September 2018. **Supervisor.**
26. Smith, H.M. The hidden sell: subversive advertising of fashion products in social media. Master of Applied Arts in Fashion. Graduated September 2018. **Co-Supervisor.**
27. Sawula, N.L. The accessibility of Further Education and Training Colleges to South African Sign Language users in KwaZulu-Natal. Master of Language Practice. Graduated April 2019. **Co-Supervisor.**
28. Kirby, L. The 'blend' in blended learning: establishing a balance between face-to-face and online learning in a foundation phase pattern-making and garment construction class. Master of Applied Arts in Fashion. Graduated *cum laude* May 2020. **Co-Supervisor.**
29. Blose, M. Exploring gender identities of females from townships in Durban as represented and negotiated through stereotypes in the South African soap operas *Generations: The Legacy* and *Isidingo: The Need*. PhD (Media Studies, UKZN). Graduated November 2021. **Co-Supervisor.**
30. Ngcongco-James, N.N. Developing a method for creative interpretation of traditional dramatic texts in post-apartheid theatre: a case study of Shakespearean interpretation at the University of KwaZulu-Natal. PhD (Drama and Performance Studies, UKZN). Graduated November 2021. **Supervisor.**
31. Reddy, P. The development of a computerized simulation model to guide the South African higher education sector in short and long-term planning of TEL infrastructure. PhD (Information Technology). Graduated September 2023. **Supervisor.**
32. Madi, S.A. A narrative self-study of English Second Language teaching practice in Foundational Hospitality Management at Durban University of Technology. Master of Education in Adult and Community Education. **Supervisor.**
33. Nxumalo, T.A. The suitability of SANS 434:2018 women's measurements for body shapes of South African women who wear PPE for work purposes in eThekweni Municipality DSW Department Master of Applied Arts in Fashion. **Supervisor.**
34. Lepheana, N. Appreciative inquiry into aspects of the Basotho culture to develop innovative fashion. Master of Applied Arts in Fashion. Graduated *cum laude* May 2024. **Supervisor.**

35. Zama, M.L. The influence of social media in enhancing the learning of visual literacy in Graphic Design in tertiary education. Master of Applied Arts in Graphic Design. **Supervisor.**
36. Muindi, T.H. The framing of social protests in press photography: a case study of how photojournalism characterized and impacted on the July 2021 unrest in KwaZulu-Natal. PhD in Visual and Performing Arts. Graduated May 2024. **Supervisor.**
37. Bakwadi, K.M. Creative arts industries as a source of economic empowerment in Botswana: an Innovative Entrepreneurship approach. PhD in Visual and Performing Arts. **Supervisor.**
38. Ngcobo, D.T. Photography as a tool for social activism of sustainability towards low and zero-waste living methods for climate change through fashion. Master of Applied Arts in Photography. **Supervisor.**

Candidates supervised included eleven DUT staff, so that supervision performed a mentoring role for staff as well as improving staff qualifications. Professor Pratt also mentors DUT supervisors by co-supervising.

EXAMINER DUTIES (HIGHER DEGREE STUDENTS)

External Examiner:

- MA in Oral Studies (UKZN 2000)
- PhD in Education (UKZN 2010)
- Honours in the *Language Learning and Teaching in Multicultural Society* Module (UKZN 2010)
- MEd (CUT 2015)
- PhD in English (UKZN 2021)

Internal Examiner (DUT):

- MTech in Maths Education (2007)
- Master's in Chiropractic (2015)
- Master's in Chiropractic (2017)

RESEARCH PROJECTS

Written Composition

Professor Pratt has been engaged in research into written composition since 1986, developing an original video protocol analysis method, and carrying out over 50 case studies using this methodology with the following groups:

- Secondary school pupils at Danville Park Girls' High (1986)
- Law students at the University of Natal (1991)
- Education, Political Science and Social Science students at Technikon Natal (1993)
- Commerce students at Technikon Natal (1995)
- Electronic Engineering students at Technikon Natal (1999)
- Town and Regional Planning students at the Durban University of Technology (2005)

Lecturer replacement was funded by the NRF in 1999, and Technikon Natal allocated a grant for the purchase of the specialist research equipment used in the video protocols. The *Writing Clinic* project, funded by a Teaching Development

Grant from 2006-2008, while not a research project per se, generated sufficient research data for three international conference papers, two of which were published in peer-refereed journals.

Systemic modelling in communication, curriculum design and research

From 2008-2011 she has carried out research in piloting a mixed mode writing clinic, in collaboration with English Department staff. She has also carried out research into the application to communication, curriculum design and research of the interactive principle developed in her doctorate, with the results being published in conference papers, journal articles and a book (*Scenarios for learning: an integrated approach*). Her pioneering work on use of ICT for research development (capacity building and administration) has been published in conference papers and journal articles. Her work in systemic modelling also has relevance for the Space Science research focus area in terms of its application to communication systems, both human and cybernetic (Prof Pratt was invited to join this research area in 2012, see http://www.dut.ac.za/space_science/prof_pratt)

Language and Literacy Research Area

In view of the urgent need to address the issues of language and literacy to foster not only academic but also economic empowerment, Professor Pratt also co-ordinated a research focus area in Language and Literacy. Language Practice is currently the only FAD programme which offers a doctorate, and over 40 masters and doctoral students are registered (or have recently graduated) at DUT in the research area of language and/or literacy. Apart from their research projects, many of these students are teachers or teacher trainers focusing on language and/or literacy acquisition and development in their professional capacity. Setting up a research focus area in language and literacy enabled staff and students to network not only for research purposes but also to support the many community projects in which they were engaged. The term "literacy" includes digital literacy, and so far seven masters and doctoral research projects registered in Language Practice have involved digital artefacts and/or e-learning.

Writing Tutor Program

Professor Pratt is currently involved in updating NEWT, the Writing Tutor application produced in her PhD, to work with Windows 10 (and 11). She is also adapting the application for use on an interactive website to lead students through the process of writing a dissertation or thesis.

FUNDING

NRF and Technikon Natal funding of over R30,000 was received for research into written composition.

TDG funding of over R400,000 was granted for the *Writing Clinic* project.

CRMD Research award 2005: R24,028.80

CRMD Research award 2006: R4,626.53

DHET Ad hoc Publications Funding 2013: R190,443.20

Most of her current funding comes from research publications and supervision.

PEER REVIEWED JOURNAL/BOOK PUBLICATIONS

Pratt, D.D. (in press) Supervisor feedback to students engaged in thesis writing: a critical realist approach. In: S. Moyo and J. Palmer (eds.) *Transformative supervisor-student communication in postgraduate research supervision*. UJ Press.

Ngcongco-James, N.N. and Pratt, D.D. (in press) "Brave new world" revisited: Drama Education in a virtual landscape. In: G.F. Kehdinga (ed.) *Curriculum studies in times of crisis*. Sun Media.

Ngcongco-James, N.N. and Pratt, D.D. (2020/21) Brave new world: decolonising Shakespeare in the Drama Education curriculum. In: G.F. Kehdinga and S.B. Khoza (eds.) *Curriculum theorising: the African perspective*. Rotterdam: Brill Sense, 177-198.

Pratt, D.D. and Bhorat, A.H.M. (2015) The curated Internet portal: a morphogenetic approach to digital multimedia for college resources. In A.V. Stavros (ed.) *Advances in communications and media research, Vol 11*. New York: Nova Science Publishers, 89-142.

Pratt, D.D. and Peat, B.M. (2014) Vanishing point – or meeting in the middle? Student/supervisor transformation in a self-study thesis. *International Journal for Transformative Research* 1(1): 1-17 (http://www.internationaltransformative.com/images/PDFPapers/Peat_Pratt.pdf).

Pratt, D.D. (2014) Effective integration of ICT in blended learning programmes: a morphogenetic approach. *The International Journal of Learning in Higher Education*, 20(2): 89-103 (<http://ijlhc.cgpublisher.com/product/pub.260/prod.57/m.1>)

Pratt, D.D. (2014) The Internet as social system: applying Margaret Archer's theory of morphogenesis to hypermedia communication. *Journal of Systemics, Cybernetics and Informatics*, 12(1): 5-9 ([http://www.iiisci.org/journal/CV\\$/sci/pdfs/SA368CF13.pdf](http://www.iiisci.org/journal/CV$/sci/pdfs/SA368CF13.pdf)).

Pratt, D.D. (2013) A systems approach to modelling communicative processes. In V. Tuzlukov (ed.) *Communication systems: new research*. New York: Nova Science Publishers, 381-413.

Pratt, D.D. (2011) *Scenarios for learning: an integrated approach*. Saarbrücken: Lambert Academic Publishers [ISBN 978-3-8443-1908-8].

Pratt, D.D. (2011) *Modelling written communication: a new systems approach to modelling in the social sciences*. Methodos Series, Dordrecht: Springer [ISBN 978-90-481-9842-9].

Pratt, D.D. (2010) *Protocols and processes: a case book of video protocol analyses in written composition*. Saarbrücken: Lambert Academic Publishers [ISBN 978-3-8383-9258-5].

Pratt, D.D. (2009) Composition theory in practice: piloting a mixed mode writing clinic at the Durban University of Technology. *International Journal of Learning* 16(1): 169-184 (<http://ijl.cgpublisher.com/product/pub.30/prod.2002>).

Pratt, D.D. (2007) No middle ground, but many mansions: design features of effective mixed mode courses. *SAJHE* 21(6) *Special Edition NADEOSA 2006*:705-720.

Pratt, D.D. (2006) Social transformation and software design: a critical realist approach to the teaching of written composition. *International Journal of Learning*, 13:153-164 (<http://ijl.cgpublisher.com/product/pub.30/prod.1095>).

Pratt, D.D. (2005) Mixed-mode Communication courses at a multicultural technikon: a pilot study combining web-based learning and an Internet search project with face-to-face classroom instruction. In S. P. Schaffer and M. L. Price (eds.), *Interactive convergence: critical issues in multimedia*, Vol. 10: 143 - 170. Oxford, UK: Inter-Disciplinary Press (<http://www.inter-disciplinary.net/publishing/id-press/ebooks/interactive-convergence-critical-issues-in-multimedia/>).

Pratt, D.D. (2004) The Comm. Skills Online project: a tentative exploration of the interrelationship between traditional page-bound literacy, computer literacy and the development of academic literacy. *International Journal of Learning*, 11:1739-1746 (<http://ijl.cgpublisher.com/product/pub.30/prod.475>).

Pratt, D.D. (1990) The process approach to writing. In K. Chick (ed.) *Searching for relevance*. Durban: South African Applied Linguistics Association: 453-468.

Pratt, D.D. (1988) A process approach to writing. In M.J. Marwick (ed.) *High School Ideas for ENGM July 1988*. Natal Education Department: Language and Publications Service: 142-148.

Pratt, D.D. (1987) Some ideas aimed at making pupils' writing more effective. *English First Language*, Natal Education Department, May 1987.

PEER REVIEWED INTERNATIONAL CONFERENCE PROCEEDINGS

Reddy, P. and Pratt, D.D. (2024) A systemic model for evaluating online course design: a critical realist approach. In: *Proceedings of 18th International Technology, Education and Development Conference*. Valencia, Spain, 4-6 March, 2024. 6892-6901. Available: <https://doi.org/10.21125/inted.2024.1818> (Accessed 12 March 2024).

Pratt, D.D. (2015) My MOOC and other animals: options for online research capacity building at a University of Technology. *Proceedings of NADEOSA 2015 Conference*, Durban University of Technology, South Africa, 7-9 July 2015.

Pratt, D.D. (2013) Effective integration of ICT in blended learning programmes: a morphogenetic approach. *Proceedings of 20th International Conference on Learning*. Rhodes, Greece, 11-13 July 2013. 89-183.

Pratt, D.D. (2013) The Internet as social system: applying Margaret Archer's theory of morphogenesis to hypermedia communication. *Proceedings of 17th World Multi-Conference on Systemics, Cybernetics and Informatics (WMSCI 2013)*. Orlando, Florida, USA, 9-12 July 2013. 5-9.

Pratt, D.D. (2013) Transforming social structure with ICT in research capacity building at a multicultural university of technology. *Proceedings of EdMedia 2013*. Victoria, British Columbia, 24-28 June 2013. 856-861.

Bosman, P.J., Pratt, D.D. and Wilson, L. (2013) An exploration of the current status quo of animal chiropractic in South Africa. Poster presentation accepted for *World Federation of Chiropractic Conference (WFC 2013)*. Durban, South Africa, 10-13 April.

- Pratt, D.D. (2010) Bridging the continental divide: a reflective account of online distance supervision at the Durban University of Technology. Proceedings of *NADEOSA 2010 Conference*. Potchefstroom, South Africa, 6-8 September 2010.
- Pratt, D.D. (2009) A systems approach to the teaching/research nexus as applied in a mixed mode research module for BTech Journalism. Proceedings of *7th International Conference on Education and Information Systems, Technologies and Applications (EISTA 2009)*. Orlando, Florida, USA, 10-13 July 2009.
- Pratt D.D. (2009) Composition theory in practice: piloting a mixed-mode writing clinic at the Durban University of Technology. Proceedings of *16th International Conference on Learning*. University of Barcelona, Spain, 1-4 July 2009. [Published in the *International Journal of Learning*.]
- Pratt, D.D. (2008) The use of ICT for research development in the Humanities at a multicultural University of Technology. Proceedings of *NADEOSA 2008 Conference*. University of Pretoria, Groenkloof Campus, 18-19 August 2008.
- Pratt, D.D. and Peppas, M. (2008) The BTech Research Module for Journalism: theoretical aspects of course design in developing research capacity through blended learning. Proceedings of *3rd International Conference on e-Learning (ICEL 2008)*. University of Cape Town, 26-27 June 2008: 371-378.
- Pratt, D.D. (2007) Introducing newt@dut: a mixed mode writing clinic at a multicultural university of technology. Proceedings of *14th International Conference on Learning*. Johannesburg, South Africa, 26-29 June 2007.
- Pratt, D.D. (2006) From social algorithm to pedagogical application: some implications for educational software. Proceedings of *9th IASTED International Conference on Computers and Advanced Technology in Education (CATE 2006)*. Lima, 4-6 October 2006: 139-145.
- Pratt, D.D. and Gutteridge, R. (2006) The role of the social mechanism in social transformation: a critical realist approach to blended learning. Proceedings of *8th Annual Conference on World Wide Web Applications*. Bloemfontein, 6-8 September 2006.
- Pratt, D.D. (2006) No middle ground, but many mansions: how a consideration of the functional architecture of communication can assist the design of effective mixed mode courses. Proceedings of *NADEOSA 10th Anniversary Conference*, Pretoria, 23-24 August 2006. [Revised version published in *SAJHE*.]
- Pratt, D.D. (2006) Social transformation and software design: a critical realist approach to the teaching of written composition. Proceedings of *13th International Conference on Learning*. Montego Bay, Jamaica, 22-25 June 2006. [Published in the *International Journal of Learning*.]
- Pratt, D.D. (2006) Modelling social algorithms as design templates for educational software. Proceedings of *IADIS Virtual Multi Conference on Computer Science and Systems (MCCIS 2006)*, 15-19 May 2006: 255-262.
- Pratt, D.D. (2005) Comm. Skills Online three years down the line: reflecting on design principles in blended learning. Proceedings of *7th Annual Conference on World Wide Web Applications*. Cape Technikon, Cape Town, 29-31 August 2005. (<http://www.uj.ac.za/www2005/documents/Pratt,%20DD.pdf>). (N.B. No longer available at this address.)

Pratt, D.D. (2005) An analysis of the design features of three mixed-mode courses in a master's degree programme. *Proceedings of IASTED International Conference on Education and Technology (ICET 2005)*. Alberta, Canada, July 4-6 2005: 135-141.

Pratt, D.D. (2005) Modelling writing as the basis for a writing tutor computer program. *Proceedings of Ed-Media World Conference on Educational Multimedia, Hypermedia and Telecommunications*. Montreal, Canada, 27 June-2 July 2005: 786-791.

Pratt, D.D. (2005) Social mechanism and software design: the use of a stochastic social-process algorithm in the design of a writing tutor program. *Proceedings of 3rd International Conference on Computer Science and its Applications (ICCSA-2005)*. San Diego, California, USA, June 27-30, 2005: 249-254.

Pratt, D.D. (2004) The Comm. Skills Online project: a tentative exploration of the interrelationship between traditional page-bound literacy, computer literacy and the development of academic literacy. *Proceedings of 11th International Literacy and Education Research Network Conference on Learning*. Cojimar Pedagogical Convention Centre Havana, Cuba, 27-30 June 2004.

Pratt, D.D. (2003) The matrix reloaded: the role of the web-based learning project in integrating and coordinating mixed-mode learning interactions. *Proceedings of 5th Annual Conference on World Wide Web Applications*. UDW, Durban, South Africa, 10-12 September 2003. (<http://general.rau.ac.za/infosci/www2003/Papers/Pratt,%20D%20The%20matrix%20reloaded.pdf>).

Peté, M., Fregona, C.M.M., Fedderke, E. and Pratt, D.D. (2003) Continuing development of Web-based learning and teaching at the Durban Institute of Technology through a community of practice. *Proceedings of 5th Annual Conference on World Wide Web Applications*. UDW, Durban, South Africa, 10-12 September 2003.

Pratt, D.D. (2003) Mixed-mode Communication courses at a multicultural technikon: a pilot study combining web-based learning and an Internet search project with face-to-face classroom instruction. *Proceedings of 1st Global Conference Interactive Convergence: Research in Multimedia*. Prague, Czech Republic, 7-9 August 2003. www.inter-disciplinary.net/ci/mm/mm1/pratt%20paper.pdf [Revised and expanded into a book chapter publication in S. P. Schaffer and M. L. Price (eds.), *Interactive convergence: critical issues in multimedia*, Vol. 10: 143 - 170. Oxford, UK: Inter-Disciplinary Press (<http://www.inter-disciplinary.net/publishing/id-press/ebooks/interactive-convergence-critical-issues-in-multimedia/>).

Pratt, D.D. (2003) Blended learning as a response to change in a merged technikon. *Proceedings of NTESU Conference*. University of Natal, Durban, South Africa, 9-11 July 2003. (<http://www.ntesu.org.za/html/conference/papers/pratt.pdf>).

INTERNATIONAL/NATIONAL CONFERENCE PAPERS/WORKSHOPS

Ngcongo-James, N. N. and Pratt, D. D. (2022). Providing 'presence' in Drama Education during the pandemic: a blended learning solution. Paper presented at the *SAERA 2022 9th Annual Conference - Education in Transition: Challenges and Opportunities*. University of the Western Cape, Cape Town, 26-28 October 2022.

Pratt, D.D. (2018) Blended learning workshop on research orientations, theories and related terms. *USDP Phakamisa Project*, 23-24 July 2018, Coastlands Umhlanga Hotel and Conference Centre/Durban University of Technology.

Ngcongo, N.N. and Pratt, D.D. (2016) '400 years later, the Bard still rocks': modelling interpretation of Shakespearean drama on Moodle. Paper presented at the *10th Annual UKZN Teaching and Learning Conference (TLHEC10)*, Southern Sun Elangeni and Maharani Hotel, Durban, 20-22 September 2016.

Makhubela, L., McPherson, M., Mienie, A., Mostafa, M., Motsie, S., Pratt, D.D. and Wieder, K. (2014) Teaching in Postgraduate Education. Panel presentation and discussion at the *Seventh Annual SATN Conference 2014*. Fairmont Zimbali Lodge, KwaZulu-Natal, 14-16 October 2014.

Pratt, D.D. (2009) Modelling composition as the basis for interventions in academic writing. Invited to present paper at the *Writing Centre Indaba*, theme: writing in the disciplines. University of Witwatersrand, Johannesburg, 14 February 2009.

Pratt, D.D. (2008) *NEWT* (the New Electronic Writing Tutor): versatile composition software based on doctoral research into writing. Presentation given at the request of the *South African Writers' Circle*, Westville Library, Durban, 8 September 2008.

Pratt, D.D. and Peppas, M. (2008) Showcasing innovative technology-enhanced learning initiatives, comprising professionally-relevant software, mixed-mode undergraduate courses, and postgraduate research modules. Interactive Educational Technology workshop presented at the *SASCE 2008 Conference*. Albert Luthuli Convention Centre, Durban, 19 - 22 May 2008.

Pratt, D.D. (2005) Joint presentation with R. Gutteridge and L. Herbert: What makes groups work? An experiential workshop in small-group interaction. Workshop presented at the *South African Academic Development Conference, Transforming from within*. Durban Institute of Technology, Durban, 27 - 30 November 2005.

Babulall, A., Dewan, F. Naidoo, P. and Pratt, D.D. (2004) Social challenges facing Africa's children. Electronic poster presented at *9th SAAMFT International Conference, In Search of the Soul of Africa*. Durban ICC, 17-19 May 2004.

Pratt, D.D. (2004) There's an agent in my virtual classroom! The use of animated pedagogical characters for self-directed learning in a WebCT environment. Paper presented at the *WebCT Innovative Impact Conference (2nd WebCT Users' Conference in Africa)*. University of Stellenbosch, 5-6 April 2004.

Pratt, D.D. (2004) The matrix revolutions: integrating technology with the development of professional communication skills in mixed-mode learning interactions. Paper presented at an international workshop, *E-learning in Residential Tertiary Institutions – is it Worth all the Fuss?* University of the North, Limpopo, South Africa, 18–19 February 2004.

Pratt, D.D. (2003) Joint presentation with M. Peté, C.M.M. Fregona and E. Fedderke: Continuing development of web-based learning and teaching at the Durban Institute of Technology through a community of practice. Paper presented at the *5th Annual Conference on World Wide Web Applications*. UDW, Durban, South Africa, 10-12 September 2003.

Pratt, D.D. (2003) My writing, my dreams, my self: writing as intra-psychic communication made public. Workshop for the *Seminar of the South African Writers Circle*. Westville, Durban, South Africa, 11 October 2003.

Pratt, D.D. (2003) A survivor's guide to mergers. Paper presented at the *NTESU Conference*. University of Natal, Durban, South Africa, 9 - 11 July 2003.

Pratt, D.D. (2003) The making of CourseMaker, a web-based shell program which can be set up by the teacher to run online courses. Paper presented at the *SACOMM Conference*. DIT, Durban, South Africa: 25 -27 June 2003.

Pratt, D.D. (2002) WebCT for Dummies. Workshop for *CurriCTulum ConnICTION Conference* at Hilton College, 1-3 October 2002, and run subsequently at DIT for staff induction in both the Pioneers and Cadets programmes. This workshop was also run at:

- The Pioneers 2003 Launch at DIT in December 2002.
- The English and Communication Department's introduction to WebCT in January 2003.
- University of Limpopo in February 2003 by M. Pete and C.M.M. Fregona to introduce academics to WebCT.

Pratt, D.D. (2002) The designing of an Online Research Module for the purpose of developing research capacity at master's level as well as advanced computer literacy. Paper presented at the *SAALT Conference*, 4-6 July 2002.

- The same paper was also presented at the *SAARDHE Conference*, 8-10 July 2002.

Pratt, D.D. (2002) Changing partners: inner dialogues and creativity in writing. Workshop for the *South African Writers' Circle*. Westville, Durban, South Africa, 9 February 2002.

IN-HOUSE PAPERS AND WORKSHOPS

Pratt, D.D. (2023) Supervisor feedback to students writing a thesis. *English for Research Purposes: Selected Papers* (Blog). Available: <https://gravitysa.co.za/researchnet/course/view.php?id=5> (Accessed 12 November 2023).

Pratt, D. D. (2023) Writer's block in thesis writing. *English for Research Purposes: Selected Papers* (Blog). Available: <https://gravitysa.co.za/researchnet/course/view.php?id=5> (Accessed 25 November 2023).

Pratt, D.D. (2019) Designed and ran mixed-mode workshops for Adult and Community Education master's students using *ACE Masters Resources* web page on Moodle.

Pratt, D.D. (2017) Designed and ran mixed-mode *English for Research Purposes* workshops (ongoing) for DUT master's and PhD students.

Pratt, D.D. (2016) Research orientations, theories and related terms. *English for Research Purposes: Selected Papers*. Available: <https://gravitysa.co.za/researchnet/course/view.php?id=5> (Accessed 14 March 2018).

Pratt, D.D. (2016) The research problem cycle. *English for Research Purposes: Selected Papers*. Available: <https://gravitysa.co.za/researchnet/course/view.php?id=5> (Accessed 10 October 2023).

Pratt, D.D. (2016) The role of thesis structure in presenting a thesis argument. *English for Research Purposes: Selected Papers*. Available: <https://gravitysa.co.za/researchnet/course/view.php?id=5> (Accessed 8 May 2016).

Pratt, D.D. (2016) The systemic nature of the research process. *English for Research Purposes: Selected Papers*. Available: <https://gravitysa.co.za/researchnet/course/view.php?id=5> (Accessed 10 May 2018).

Pratt, D.D. (2012) Designed and ran 28 *Research Capacity Building Workshops* for the Research Capacity Building Directorate from January - November 2012. Available at: <https://tlzprod.dut.ac.za/course/view.php?id=10006>.

Pratt, D.D. (2012) *Key issues concerning PG 4 and all that...* Workshop Presentation given at Department of Public Management and Economics Workshop held on 7th and 8th June 2012.

Pratt, D.D. (2011) *Supervision workshop*. Presented for Faculty of Health Sciences staff at Tromso Annexe, Durban University, 14 November 2011.

Pratt, D.D. (2011) *Thesis writing workshop*. Presented for the PMB Research Focus Group at Riverside Campus, Durban University of Technology, 3 June 2011.

17 May 2011: *Proposal writing workshop*. Presented at the BM Patel Research Commons, ML Sultan Campus, Durban University of Technology, 17 May 2011.

Pratt, D.D. (2011) *Research writing: theses/dissertations*. Workshop presented at the Hotel School Conference Venue, Ritson Campus, Durban University of Technology, 30 and 31 March 2011.

Pratt, D.D. (2011) *Software and social networking for building research capacity*. Workshop presented at the RMD Research Boardroom, Tromso Annexe, Steve Biko Campus, Durban University of Technology, 8 February 2011.

Pratt, D.D. (2009) Conference Chair and Editor of Proceedings of *FAD 2009 Conference: focus on creative output*. Hotel School Conference Venue, Durban University of Technology, 3-5 June 2009.

Pratt, D.D. (2008) FAD developmental research plan. *In-house management leadership presentation to HODs and Programme Leaders*. Room 21, City Campus, DUT, 8 October 2008.

Pratt, D.D. (2008) Courses and resources: versatile web course tools. Paper presented at *e-Learning Day*. Cane Growers' Hall, ML Sultan Campus, Durban University of Technology, 5 June 2008.

Pratt, D.D. (2007) Research workshop for the Photography Department at DUT. City Campus, 22-23 November 2007.

Pratt, D.D. and Peppas, M. (2007) The BTech Research Module: developing research capacity through blended learning. In-house paper presented at the *Faculty of Arts and Design Research Day*. Durban, 19 September 2007.

Pratt, D.D. (2006). Arts Faculty *Quality Assurance Workshop*. Hotel School, Ritson Campus, DUT, 25 May 2006.

Pratt, D.D. (2005) Civilizing Civil Engineering students: integrated online project work in a Comm. Skills course. Paper presented at the *Pioneers Online In-House Conference*. Durban Institute of Technology. Durban, 6 – 8 December 2005

Pratt, D.D. (2005) Theoretical modelling in the Social Sciences: a theoretical model of written composition. Paper presented at the *DIT Arts Faculty Research Day*. Durban, 16 February 2005.

Pratt, D.D. (2005) Joint presentation with R. Gutteridge, L. Herbert and G.D.J. Stewart: Comm. Skills Online two years down the line: reflecting on design principles in blended learning. Paper presented at the *DIT Arts Faculty Research Day*. Durban, 16 February 2005.

Gutteridge, R., Herbert, L. and Pratt, D.D. (2003) The Comm. Skills Online Project: a tentative exploration of the interrelationship between traditional page-bound literacy, computer literacy and the development of academic literacy. Paper presented at the *DIT Research Day*. Durban, 23 October 2003.

DISSERTATION/THESIS TITLES

Pratt, D.D. (1987) A process approach: the formulation of a simplified conceptual framework showing the stages of the writing process, and an investigation into the effects on writing behaviour of communicating this framework directly to the learner. Unpublished master's dissertation, University of Natal, Durban.

Pratt, D.D. (2007) A realist approach to writing: developing a theoretical model of written composition to inform a computer mediated learning application. Unpublished doctoral thesis, Durban University of Technology, Durban. <http://ir.dut.ac.za:8080/jspui/handle/10321/332>.

ELECTRONIC ARTEFACTS

NEWT writing tutor program ©2005, developed for commercial use, 2006-2008.

CourseMaker short course and lesson shell ©2005.

Journal of Arts and Design. <http://www.dut.ac.za/site/awdep.asp?depnum=31933> [no longer available], previously set up on online multimedia portal in "tikiwiki" format, then running off link to Faculty of Arts and Design page).

The *NEWT* writing tutor is currently being updated to work with Windows 10 (and 11).

WEB BASED LEARNING

The following are some of the web-based courses which Professor Pratt designed, created and ran from 2002-2022:

Higher degree courses

CALT Research Module

CALT Online

The BTech Research Module for Journalism.

The BTech Research Module for Television.

The BTech Research Module for TIP (Translation and Interpreting Practice)

The MTech Research Module for Journalism.

Moodle forums for individual masters and doctoral supervision .

The DUT PGDS Forum

English for Research Purposes: Course

English for Research Purposes: Selected Papers

The Higher Degrees Research Module (multi-disciplinary)

Research Matters

The Research MOOC

English/Communication courses for undergraduate students

.dutcom (a resource centre for English Language Programmes, on WebCT 4 and 6)
Comm. Skills Online for Chemistry, Dental Technology, Electrical Engineering, Civil Engineering, Maritime Engineering and Survey
Communication for Child and Youth Development, Town and Regional Planning,
Communication in Video 1, English for Arts (a Foundation course)
.WebCT for Dummies - Student Version
English Materials Development

Staff induction into web-based learning

Space Cadets
WebCT for Dummies

Research administration courses

Arts and Design FRC Online
FAD Research Forum: the "Karridene Connection"
FAD Higher Degrees Forum
Sharepoint Research Information Site (for staff)
DUT Moodle Research Information Site (for students)

Research websites

The research focus area for *Language & Literacy* (<http://www.dut.ac.za/language-literacy/>) has over 20 higher degree students who have been/are involved in research projects on language and literacy, as well as staff and affiliates involved in projects in these areas. Digital literacy (including use of digital artefacts for e-learning) has been included in this focus area. In keeping with the DUT mission and vision, this webpage links up research with exemplary teaching/learning and community projects. The motto is: "Phendukela Olimini" (Transform through language).

Research Matters has been made available as an online archive of open educational resources (OERs), and a *Research MOOC* has been designed and set up to cater for research capacity building carried out completely online. *Research Matters* is at <https://tlzprod.dut.ac.za/course/view.php?id=10006> and the *Research MOOC* at <https://tlzprod.dut.ac.za/course/view.php?id=10004>. The website *English for Research Purposes: Selected Papers* has been set up for blog-type publication of papers on research processes for higher degree students as well as for courses in research English (<https://tlzprod.dut.ac.za/course/view.php?id=10057>). As part of *Postgraduate Research Support*, resources have been set up for master's and doctoral students at TLZ Moodle.

Mobile learning

Professor Pratt pioneered use of mobile learning (iPad2, Kindle, mobile phones) for research capacity building in 2012/13.

TEACHING AND LEARNING MATERIALS PROJECT

The Writing Clinic

This project is an application of doctoral research into written composition, received funding from the Teaching and Development Grant 2006 (continued in 2007 and 2008), and involves an online *Writing Clinic* with the following resources for DUT staff and students:

- An interactive webpage on the DUT server, through which teaching and learning resources are accessed.
- A free download of the Academic Writing Tutor software.

The project could thus be seen to integrate teaching and learning with research and community development.

TEACHING AND SCHOOL ADMINISTRATION BACKGROUND

Professor Pratt worked in secondary schools from 1967 to 1990, during which time she was Subject Head of English (1976-1990), HOD, i.e., “umbrella” head, of various subjects and administrative areas (1981-1990) and Acting Deputy Principal (1984, 1985 and 1988). One of the administrative areas included in her HOD portfolio was computers, when Danville Park Girls High first introduced ICT into office and academic administration in the early 1980s. It was at secondary school that she developed the integrated project (or “scenario”) approach which translated so well into learner-based courses at tertiary level.

The scenario approach has been further developed as a result of theoretical input from doctoral research. Scenario-based learning has been used very successfully at postgraduate level in developing research capacity (e.g., in the BTech Research Modules, the CALT Research Module, and the multidisciplinary Higher Degree Research Module). It has also been used in online staff induction workshops as well as in small-group staff and student workshops. A book on the approach has been published: *Scenarios for learning: an integrated approach*.